Contact

+447484990806 (Mobile)

www.linkedin.com/in/andychallen (LinkedIn)
kx.com (Company)

Top Skills

Director level
Management Professional
Stakeholder Management

Certifications

CybSafe Certification in Security Awareness
Capturing New Business
Lead Implementing and Lead Auditing ISO 22301
Mental Health First Aider

Honors-Awards

Queen's Commendation for Valuable Service
Queen's Commendation for Valuable Service

Publications

Afghanistan - A State Beyond Repair?

Andy Challen GB

I work with people in aerospace and defence technology environments. People are our most important asset, innovative tech solutions enable them.
United Kingdom

Summary

I bring operational and leadership skills from my Royal Air Force career, and commercial and government experience from my civilian career to help find solutions for our warfighters and defence partners. I am a keen advocate for innovation, developing people, and delivering results to partners through providing technological and pragmatic solutions. Do more with what you have. Maximise performance to save lives, enhance operational effectiveness, minimise risk, and maximise the output of limited resources. I am experienced at risk management in crisis and peacetime, leading and managing business change, enabling innovation, and reducing carbon footprints.I enjoy supporting the veterans community, especially those in transition to civilian life. Giving the next generation a helping hand is important too. Supporting the Jon Egging Trust and STEM Ambassador opportunities are small but important steps to help young people flourish.

Experience

KX
Account Director Aerospace and Defence
April 2025 - Present (1 year 3 months)
London Area, United Kingdom

Survival of the fastest. Providing a solution to aerospace and defence data pain points.

g2alpha Ltd
Founder and Managing Director
June 2026 - Present (1 month)
Where you need us to be

ICEYE

VP Missions UK - Joint Bid Lead with a UK Prime for a Government Contract
May 2023 - March 2025 (1 year 11 months)
United Kingdom

Helping Governments to choose a cost effective and proven Earth Observation SAR satellite capability for defence, intelligence, security, and environmental needs. Liaising with industry partners to maximise UK potential and develop a UK sovereign capability.

Inzpire Ltd
4 years 10 months

Combat Air Advisor, Innovation Champion, STEM, and Net Zero Strategy lead.
May 2021 - May 2023 (2 years 1 month)
Norfolk, England, United Kingdom

Championing ideas, helping teams with concept development, partnering with business and academia. STEM Ambassador, passionate about defence and innovation. Lead for our Net Zero by 2040 ambition.

MOD Combat Air SME Trade and Strategic Exports Team
August 2018 - May 2023 (4 years 10 months)
London, England, United Kingdom

Specialist support to Trade and Strategic Export Policy team.

Deloitte
Senior Manager
January 2015 - August 2018 (3 years 8 months)
London, United Kingdom

Chief of Staff, and Resilience and Crisis Management. One year as a Chief of Staff for a Partner. Provided partner leadership mentoring and coaching.

Internal move to Resilience and Crisis Management Team. Specialising in Risk, Resilience, Crisis Management and Corporate Security. Clients included Brussels Airport following the tragic terrorist attacks, Stansted Airport, the EU Border and Coast Guard Agency Frontex, the BBC and National Grid.

Royal Air Force
23 years 5 months

Wing Commander
July 2008 - January 2015 (6 years 7 months)

I was employed in various roles including defence diplomacy, leadership and management of diverse military and contractor personnel. I was an advisor in strategic air and space power related matters to government, industry and the public.

Royal Air Force Officer - Fast jet pilot
September 1991 - January 2015 (23 years 5 months)
UK, Europe, USA, Middle East

Leader, instructor, operator.

Staff Officer 1 Air Doctrine
December 2013 - November 2014 (1 year)
Air Warfare Group, Air Warfare Centre

Doctrine, strategy, support to operations.

Commanding Officer 906 Expeditionary Air Wing
January 2013 - September 2013 (9 months)
Middle East

I was honoured to receive the award of a second Queen's Commendation for Valuable Service (QCVS). Led a multi-service defence team of up to 500 people to develop operational and training capability with international partners as part of Operation KIPION.

Officer Commanding Operations Wing RAF Marham
January 2011 - January 2013 (2 years 1 month)

Responsible for delivering combat air operational output in times of extremely high operational tempo, leading a team of over 400 people to enable, support and refine air power. Operational Director of the entire RAF Station to support the UNSC Resolution resulting in Operation ELLAMY. Senior Operator and Deputy Duty Delivery Holder. Developed an entirely new Air Safety Management Plan and chaired several Occurrence Review Group Boards for incidents in the U.K. and Afghanistan. Lead for Business Continuity and Resilience and lead for two Friends and Family Days including Flying Display Coordinator. Flew day and night operational missions on Operation HERRICK from Kandahar Air Base Afghanistan.

Wing Commander - Air 1 British Defence Staff United States
September 2008 - September 2010 (2 years 1 month)
United States

Provided specialist combat air advice to the British Defence Staff United States, as part of the British Embassy team. Strategic and operational liaison with US Department of Defence and Secretary of the Air Force International

Affairs. Managed the RAF flying exchange programme, providing support to individuals and families deployed across the United States.

Current Ops Desk Officer
April 2006 - August 2007 (1 year 5 months)

Responsible for coordinating RAF strike attack, offensive support and ISTAR resources for global operations.

Tornado GR-1 & 4 pilot, Qualified Flying Instructor, Electronic Warfare Instructor, Flight Commander
July 1997 - March 2006 (8 years 9 months)
Global

I was honoured to receive a Queen's Commendation for Valuable Service (QCVS). Front line operational pilot and instructor, holding the highest qualifications for leadership and flying supervision including Exercise RED FLAG Mission Commander. Graduate of the NATO Tactical Leadership Programme. Qualified Flying Instructor, Electronic Warfare Instructor. Front and rear seat Air Checking Officer. Operational tours flown on Operation WARDEN, JURAL, BOLTON, RESINATE, TELIC 1 and subsequent rotations.

Defence Academy of the UK
Advanced Command and Staff Course 11
September 2007 - July 2008 (11 months)

psc(j) and MA on ACSC 11

Defence Research Paper: 'Afghanistan - A State Beyond Repair?'

BAE Systems
Engineering Apprentice
1986 - 1990 (4 years)
Dynamics Division Stevenage

I completed a 4 year British Aerospace (Dynamics), Electrical Engineering apprenticeship covering general engineering, electrical engineering on missile systems, test engineering including optics, and sales engineering in the guided weapons arena.

Education

King's College London, U. of London
Master's degree, Defence Studies · (2007 - 2008)

Chartered Management Institute

Executive Diploma in Executive and Strategic Management, International System, strategic defence, leadership. · (2008)

VIMA Group

Bristol Executive Management Programme, Business Administration, Management and Operations · (2014 - 2014)